

Here are some bicycle safety tips for riding in your neighborhood:

1. Wear a helmet: It's crucial for protecting your head in case of a fall or collision.
2. Follow traffic rules: Obey stop signs, traffic lights, and lane markings.
3. Be visible: Wear bright or reflective clothing, especially at dawn, dusk, or night.
4. Use hand signals: Indicate turns and stops to alert drivers and pedestrians.
5. Stay alert: Watch for potholes, debris, and parked cars, and be mindful of pedestrians and pets.
6. Ride defensively: Anticipate the actions of drivers and pedestrians and be prepared to react.

By following these tips, you can reduce your risk of injury and enjoy a safe ride in your neighborhood!

Main Street OPTICAL



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Community Corner, our weekly newsletter, is the go-to source for wholesome, family-friendly content that brings joy to over 1,000 readers across our community.

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Deadline to Print: Monday End of Day

For more information or to secure your advertising space, please contact us at Submissions@OurCommunityCorner.com
Let's work together to support and grow our community!

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Community Service Announcement! Lets all have a safe Shabbos and wear a reflector when going outside!

BS"D
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FRIDAY, 15 KISLEV, 5786

COMMUNITY CORNER PARSHAS VAYISHLACH וישלח



SHABBOS STARTS:

4:09 PM
(18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS:

5:17 PM
(50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM:

5:39 PM
(72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers of the Community for the Community.

STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



Rabbi Shneur Zalman (founder of Chabad Chasidism) was deeply disturbed by the intrigues and dissension that jeopardized his activities, particularly those relating to the Chasidic community in the Holy Land. He had a premonition that his own eclipse was at hand. One day, the Rebbe confided in his daughter, Devorah Leah, and expressed his utmost apprehension in regard to the future of Chasidism and to the Baal Shem Tov's teachings.

Devorah Leah realized the gravity of the situation and sensed that her father's life was linked with it. For several days she kept her anxiety to herself. Then she decided that it was her duty to divulge her secret to some of the senior Chasidim. She also resolved that she would give her life for the life of her father.

Devorah Leah asked three senior Chasidim to meet with her. She asked them to promise on oath that they would act according to her instructions, whatever they might be, and would keep in strict confidence all that she was about to tell them, until such time as it would be fitting to keep the matter secret no longer.

The three Chasidim requested time to consider. They realized that something was amiss. They had noticed that the Rebbe had secluded himself in his private room and not even they were admitted. This change in the Rebbe's routine was ominous. Undoubtedly, the Rebbe's daughter knew something that was of extreme gravity. Finally, they came to the conclusion that they had to accept Devorah Leah's conditions. The following day they presented themselves to Devorah Leah with their resolution. She began by saying:

"We are all Chasidim of my father, our Rebbe, and each one of us must be ready and willing to give his or her life for him, and for the future of Chasidism." Then she was overcome by a flood of tears.

At her distress the three Chasidim were deeply moved. One Chasid exclaimed: "I will be the first to give my life for the Rebbe and for the perpetuation of the Baal Shem Tov's teachings. I will gladly go through fire or water..."

"First," Devorah Leah interrupted, "you must swear to me by the most stringent Torah-oath which has no absolution, that you will do what I ask of you, without any mental reservation whatsoever, even if it is a matter of life."

Hearing these ominous words, they reiterated that they had already carefully weighed the matter and had agreed to abide by Devorah Leah's conditions, come what may. Thereupon the three of them gave their solemn oath as requested.

"Now I make the three of you a Beit Din (rabbinical court), and you will agree to act as a Beit Din, and to rule in accordance with the law of the Torah," Devorah Leah continued, "These were my father's words concerning the present situation in the wake of the intrigue which has cast a shadow over Chasidism:

"For 30 years a fruit-bearing tree requires cultivation and care in order to bring it to its optimum fruitfulness. It is now thirty years since the teachings of our master, the Baal Shem Tov, were firmly planted by my teacher and master, the Maggid of Mezritch, and grew into a Tree of Life. Now, the Adversary threatens to destroy it all. I do want to live, for this is the duty of every man, according to the Torah. Yet, more precious to me than life is my desire to cultivate this tree so that it continues to give its fruit until the coming of Moshiach.

"The Maggid had forewarned me of difficult times and had promised to come to my aid. I saw my teacher, but his face was overcast, an ill-omen."

"In view of this situation, I have resolved to put my life in lieu of my father's. I bequeath my life to him; I will die so that he may live a good and long life, in order to cultivate the Tree of Life. In this way I will also have a share in it."

On the first night of Rosh Hashana, after the services, Rabbi Shneur Zalman broke his custom not to speak to anyone. He asked: "Where is Devorah Leah?" When she appeared, he began to wish her the customary blessing to "be inscribed in a happy year." But she interrupted him immediately, and wished instead "to be inscribed in a happy year."

After Rosh Hashana ended, Rabbi Shneur Zalman called Devorah Leah and her husband Rabbi Shalom Shachna into his room. What was spoken there is not known, but Rabbi Shachna was heard saying: "What is to happen to the boy?"

The following day Devorah Leah passed away. Rabbi Shneur Zalman took personal charge of her young son's upbringing.

The next years saw an intensification of intolerance in certain communities towards the Chasidic approach. The extent of Rabbi Shneur Zalman's suffering became apparent on Shavuot, the anniversary of the Baal Shem Tov's passing. He was immersed in a state of profound soulful reverie.

PARSHA QUESTION By: The Rabbi

Who in this week's Parsha passed away at 180 years old?
Answer to last weeks parsha question:

- Q. What did Yaakov specify would be his payment from Lavan?
- A. All sheep and goats born with irregular coloring. was named by either Hashem or by his father.

MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadash



Parshas Vayishlach. Perek 36. Pasuk 15. "אלה אלופי בני עשו".

"These are the chiefs of the children of Eisav". Eisav's descendants are referred to as "אלופי" whereas the descendants of Yishmael are referred to as נשיאים in 21:16. What is the difference between these two words and how does it affect us?

The gemara (sanhedrin 99) states that the אלוף of Eisav, although a king, is like a king without a crown since it will end when Yakov/Mashiach rises. The משיח of Yishmael is more of an honor with no real power. Eisav is also called a משיח (Devarim 2:5, Yehoshua 23:4) which refers to him getting actual ownership of land (Bereishis 36:43). Yishmael however, was thrown out and "will not be משיח" (Bereishis 21:10). He will not "own" land as stated in Bereishis 25:16 where it describes Yishmael's "courtyards and strongholds", unlike Eisav which is described as having "land of their possession" (36:43). This is the true source of why Eisav has not fought against us about land and Yishmael continues to fight against us for land. You see, Eisav HAS land whereas Yishmael has no true ownership of land. (Rav Yitzchok Hutner said after being let free from the hijacking of his TWA flight in 1970)

TEFILLAH OF THE WEEK

Birchos Hashachar
הַשְׁמַח בְּרִיךְ אֱתָה הַמֶּלֶךְ הַגָּדוֹל
King of the Universe
רוּקֵם הָאָרֶץ עַל הַמַּיִם-Who spreads the earths above the waters
וְיָצַרְתָּ לִּי כָל צָרָתִי-Who provided me with all my needs
וְהֵכֵן לִּי מִצְעָדִי-Who prepares the steps of man
וְיִשְׁרָא אֶזְרָא-Who gives strength to Israel with strength
וְיִשְׁרָא עֲוֹנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל-Who crowns Israel with glory
וְיִשְׁרָא הַנֶּחֱמָתִי-Who gives strength to the weary



It was an awesome sight. Suddenly, Rabbi Shneur Zalman stood up and exclaimed: "Zaida (Grandfather!) (Referring to the Baal Shem Tov.) Invoke Divine mercy upon me, upon all your disciples and followers, upon the survival of your teachings! Our Heavenly Father, have mercy upon us!" Then, Rabbi Shneur Zalman fainted.

Turmoil broke loose. In the midst of the commotion, little Menachem Mendel, the orphaned son of Devorah Leah, came running into the room. Seeing his grandfather lying on the floor, he cried: "Zaidel! Zaidel!" Rabbi Shneur Zalman opened his eyes. "Zaida, take hold of my hand and get up!" the child kept saying. Reaching for the little hand, Rabbi Shneur Zalman stood up and said, "This one will comfort us!"

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